

Vincent Lindsay

Alert Investigation – Unfamiliar email sign-in

Alert ID: ra3090ce20-a151-49a2-8593-c8cd379e685f_aml

Severity level: High

Findings

Time: 10/07/2026 at 10:18 AM CST

Hostname: phoenix-vincent-vm

Host IP: 172.16.0.4

User account: Michael Scott

IOC email: [jlevinson1725@protonmail\[.\]com](mailto:jlevinson1725@protonmail[.]com)

IOC IP of sending email: 185[.]70[.]43[.]19

IOC IP address of remote server login: 136[.]244[.]66[.]209

IOC Filepath: C:\Users\MichaelScott\Downloads\mimikatz_trunk\x64\mimikatz.exe

SHA-256 Hash:

61c0810a23580cf492a6ba4f7654566108331e7a4134c968c2d6a05261b2d8a1

Correlates with: Incident #288 – Compromised Device

Investigation Summary

On 10/07/2026, at 10:18:25 AM CST, suspicious account activity pertaining to the user account Michael Scott was detected by Microsoft Defender for Endpoint. It was revealed at 10:06:53 AM that the user received a suspicious email containing a suspicious hyperlink. As a result, the user believing that they entered credentials towards a legitimate site was a credential harvesting link. Furthermore, at 10:25:13 AM CST, the user account was reported to have signed in from Great Britain - an unfamiliar location. Additionally, at 10:32:57 AM CST from Sugar Land, Texas- which was identified as a familiar location. Prior to the suspicious login, the user account was logged into at 10:10:41 AM. Following the impossible travel activity, the user account remotely logged onto the phoenix-vincent-vm at 10:28:50 AM and began to execute mimikatz.exe. In addition to mimikatz, a file named SOAPHound.exe was executed at 10:33:42 AM, which was identified to perform to the Atomic Red Team program. Additionally, at Based on the evidence and telemetry provided, this activity is malicious but based on the logs available we cannot say with confidence if the activity is still on-going. Moreover, this incident is a simulation of email, identity, and endpoint compromise, and this report treats the incident as a real incident.

Who, What, When, Where, Why & How

WHO – User account: Michael Scott, and phoenix-vincent-vm was identified to be potentially compromised.

WHAT – The account received a suspicious email containing a credential-harvesting hyperlink. Following the suspected credential compromise, the account showed suspicious sign-in activity from Great Britain and followed by a remote login to phoenix-vincent-vm and execution of mimikatz.exe.

WHEN: The suspicious email was received at 10:06:53 AM CST on 10/07/2026. The account was logged into at 10:10:41 AM, suspicious activity was detected at 10:18:25 AM, a London sign-in occurred at 10:25:13 AM, the remote login to phoenix-vincent-vm occurred at 10:28:50 AM, and a Sugar Land sign-in was recorded at 10:32:57 AM CST.

WHERE: The suspicious authentication activity originated from Great Britain, and the compromised account subsequently remotely accessed phoenix-vincent-vm.

WHY: Although this incident is a simulation of a compromise, the activity is consistent with an attacker obtaining the user's credentials through a credential-harvesting phishing link and subsequently using those credentials to access the environment. The execution of mimikatz suggests an attempt to obtain additional credentials or authentication material.

HOW: The suspected attack chain began with a phishing email, credential-harvesting link, suspected credential compromise, anomalous/impossible-travel sign-ins, remote access to the VM, mimikatz execution

Correlating Evidence with commentary

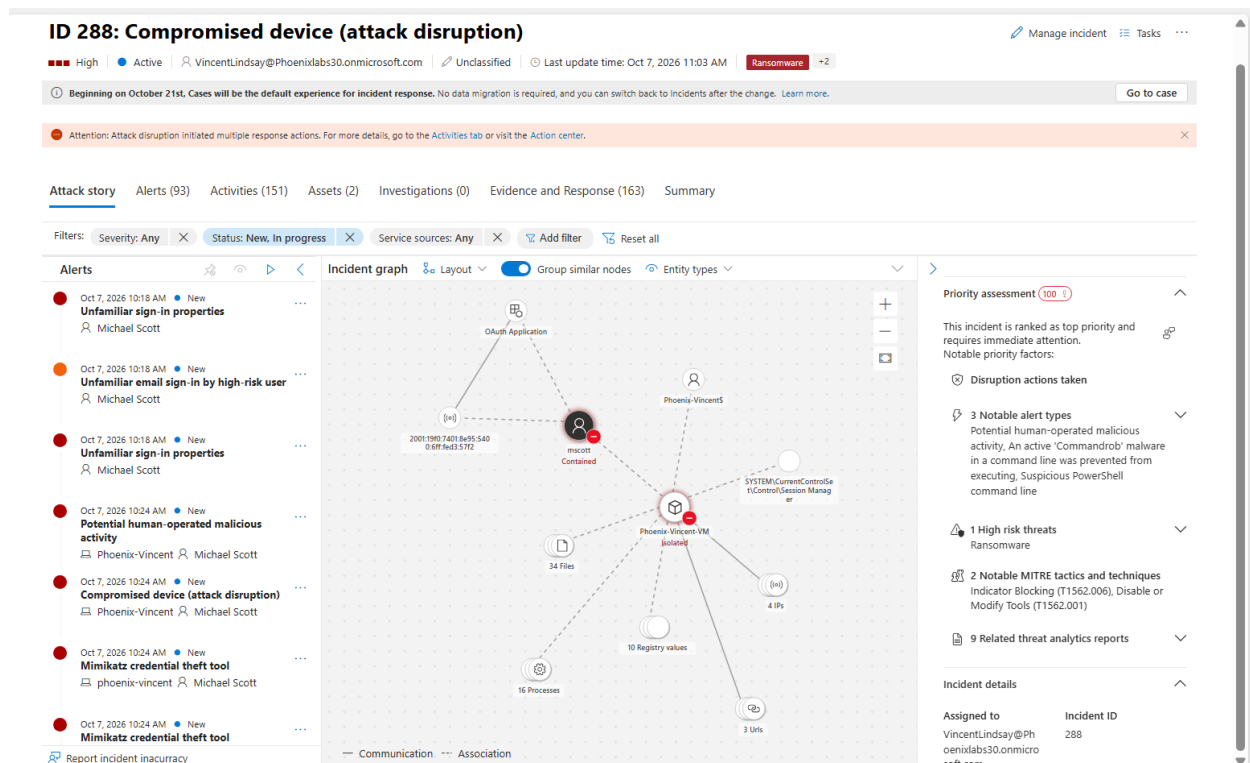


Figure 1: Initial attack summary

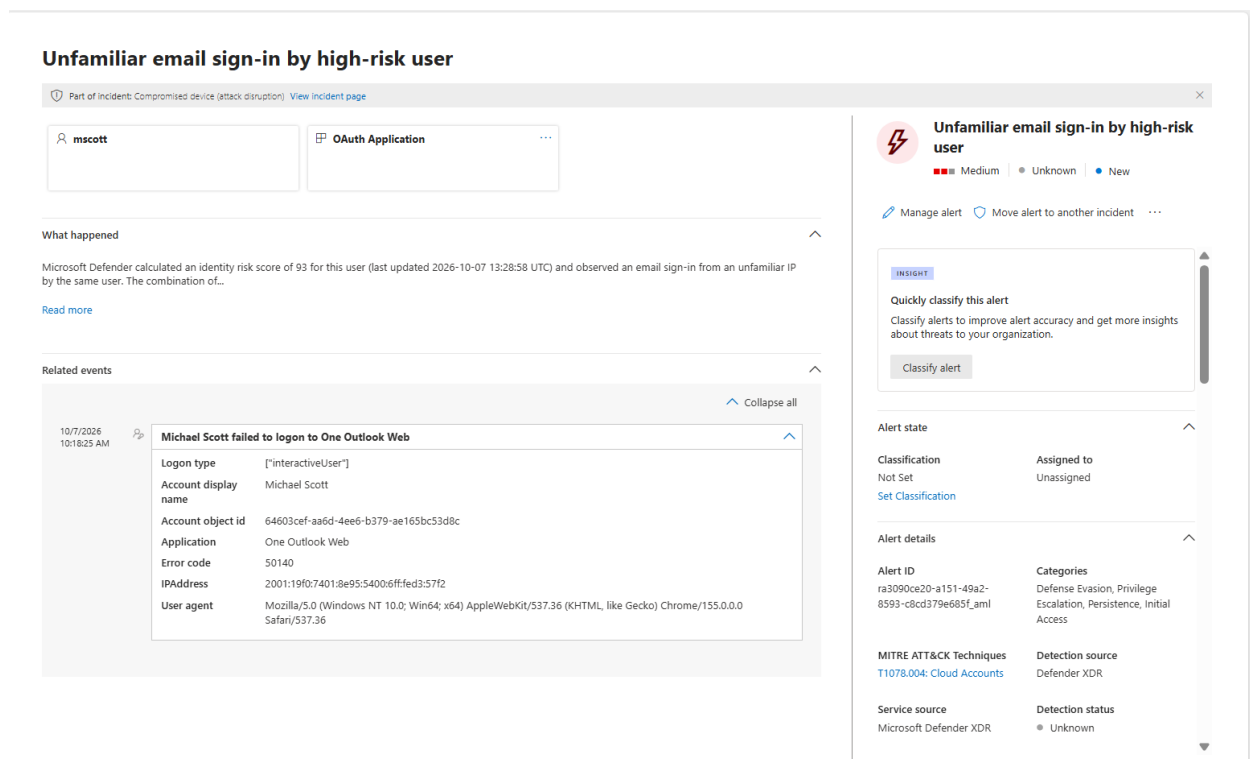


Figure 2: Process tree of alert

Once I began to understand the timeline of the alert, I began to check for any points of initial access events. As a result, I check the user Michael's email events to verify any strange emails sent before the timeline of the alert.

The screenshot shows a query interface with a query editor at the top containing two lines of code: `1 EmailEvents` and `2 | where RecipientEmailAddress == "mscott@phoenixlabs30.onmicrosoft.com"`. Below the editor is a toolbar with buttons for 'Run query', 'Create summary rule', and 'Create detection rule', along with a dropdown for '100,000 (Default)' and a date range selector for 'Last 30 days'. The results section below the toolbar shows '7 items' and a search bar. A table of results is displayed with columns: TimeGenerated, Timestamp, NetworkMessageId, InternetMessageId, SenderMailFromAd..., SenderFromAddress, and SenderDisplayName. The first row of data shows a timestamp of 'Oct 7, 2026 10:06:53 AM', a network message ID of '68b90e1a-f500-4075-11...', and a sender email address of 'jlevinson1725@proton...'. The sender display name is 'jlevinson1725'.

TimeGenerated	Timestamp	NetworkMessageId	InternetMessageId	SenderMailFromAd...	SenderFromAddress	SenderDisplayName
>	Oct 7, 2026 10:06:53 AM	68b90e1a-f500-4075-11...	<HqsR3MPAAtQ1dzv36...	jlevinson1725@proton...	jlevinson1725@proton...	jlevinson1725

Figure 3: Identifying sent email to the user

Moreover, I found a suspicious email sent to the user discussing payment for an invoice, as well as the email containing a hyperlink.

Invoice is ready for viewing.

Source

Hello Michael,

Your requested invoice is now available and ready for review. Please review and process the payment at your earliest convenience to avoid any late fees.

Invoice #: 598624

Date Issued: 10/07/2026

Amount Due: \$5,982

Due Date: 11/09/2026

You can securely view and download the invoice at the link below

[[View Invoice](#)]

If you have any questions regarding this invoice, please reply to this message or contact the billing department.

Thank you,
Accounts Payable Team

Figure 4: Initial analysis of the email's contents

To verify that the user clicked on the hyperlink contained within the email, I checked for any `UrlClickEvents` and found that the user did click on the link within the email sent prior.

Advanced hunting

Selected workspace: phoenix-vincent-law Help resources

New query* x New query* x +

Schema

- Apps & identities
 - CloudAppEvents
 - EntraIdSignInEvents
 - EntraIdSpnSignInEvents
 - GraphAPIAuditEvents
 - IdentityAccountInfo
 - IdentityDirectoryEvents
 - IdentityEvents
 - IdentityInfo
 - IdentityLogonEvents
 - IdentityQueryEvents
- Email & collaboration
 - CallActivityEvents
 - CampaignInfo
 - EmailAttachmentInfo
 - EmailEvents
 - EmailPostDeliveryEvents
 - EmailUrlInfo
 - FileMaliciousContentInfo
 - MessageEvents
 - MessagePostDeliveryEv...
 - MessageUrlInfo
 - UrlClickEvents
- Devices
 - DeviceEvents
 - DeviceFileCertificateInfo

Query

```

1 UrlClickEvents
2 | where ActionType == "ClickAllowed"
3 | where AccountUpn == "mscott@phoenixlabs30.onmicrosoft.com"
4

```

Results

2 items

TimeGenerated	Timestamp	Url	ActionType	AccountUpn	Workload	NetworkMessageId
Oct 7, 2026 10:09:58 AM	Oct 7, 2026 10:09:58 AM	https://docusign.com/	ClickAllowed	mscott@phoenixlabs30...	Email	68b90e1a-f500-4075-11b6-08df24841110

Filters: Add filter

TimeGenerated Timestamp Url ActionType AccountUpn Workload NetworkMessageId

Oct 7, 2026 10:09:58 AM Oct 7, 2026 10:09:58 AM https://docusign.com/ ClickAllowed mscott@phoenixlabs30... Email 68b90e1a-f500-4075-11b6-08df24841110

TimeGenerated Oct 7, 2026 10:09:58 AM

Timestamp Oct 7, 2026 10:09:58 AM

Url https://docusign.com/

ActionType ClickAllowed

AccountUpn mscott@phoenixlabs30.onmicrosoft.com

Workload Email

NetworkMessageId 68b90e1a-f500-4075-11b6-08df24841110

IPAddress [2600:1700:10f9:3bb0:4a1:f83:65dd:5891]

IsClickedThrough 0

UrlChain ["https://docusign.com/", "https://www.docusign.com/"]

ReportId 8a70c093-ca25-4416-6361-08df24850db2

AppName Mail

AppVersion 0.0.0000

Figure 5: Scoping out event timeline

Now that we've confirmed that the user clicked on the email address, I verified if any unusual sign events occurred following the delivery of the email. As a result, we can see that the user account was logged into once prior to the incident, and then the account was logged in from Great Britain.

Advanced hunting Selected workspace: phoenix-vincent-law Help resources

[New query](#) [New query](#) +

Schema Search

- Agents
 - AgentsInfo
- Microsoft Sentinel
 - AWSCloudTrail
 - CommonSecurityLog
 - CrowdStrikeAlerts
 - CrowdStrikeDetections
 - CrowdStrikeHosts
 - CrowdStrikeVulnerabilit...
 - GCPAuditLogs
 - SecurityAlert
 - SecurityEvent
 - SecurityIncident
 - Watchlist
- LogManagement
 - AuditLogs
 - Operation
 - SecurityCaseEvent
 - SigninLogs
 - Usage
- Custom Logs
 - AuditLogsHunting_CL
 - azureActivity_adele_CL
 - AzureActivity_CL
 - disable_accounts_CL
 - MailGuard365_Threats...
 - model_evasion_detecti...

Query Run query

```
1 SigninLogs
2 | where Identity == "Michael Scott"
3 | where ResultSignature == "success"
4 | project TimeGenerated, ResultSignature, UserDisplayName, Location, IPAddress, ResourceDisplayName
5
```

Results Query history Getting started

8 items Search 0001.360 Low

Filters: [Add filter](#)

	TimeGenerated	ResultSignature	UserDisplayName	Location	IPAddress	ResourceDisplayNa...
☐	> Oct 7, 2026 12:49:...	SUCCESS	Michael Scott	US	[redacted] 2600:1700:10f9:3bb0...	Azure Resource Manager
☐	> Oct 7, 2026 10:10:...	SUCCESS	Michael Scott	US	[redacted] 2600:1700:10f9:3bb0...	Office 365 Exchange Onl...
☐	> Oct 7, 2026 10:23:...	SUCCESS	Michael Scott	US	[redacted] 2600:1700:10f9:3bb0...	Office 365 Exchange Onl...
☐	> Oct 7, 2026 10:25:...	SUCCESS	Michael Scott	GB	[redacted] 2001:19f0:7401:8e95...	Office 365 Exchange Onl...
☐	> Oct 7, 2026 10:31:...	SUCCESS	Michael Scott	GB	[redacted] 2001:19f0:7401:8e95...	Office 365 Exchange Onl...
☐	> Oct 7, 2026 10:31:...	SUCCESS	Michael Scott	GB	[redacted] 2001:19f0:7401:8e95...	Office 365 Exchange Onl...
☐	> Oct 7, 2026 10:31:...	SUCCESS	Michael Scott	GB	[redacted] 2001:19f0:7401:8e95...	Microsoft Remote Desk...
☐	> Oct 7, 2026 10:32:...	SUCCESS	Michael Scott	US	[redacted] 2600:1700:10f9:3bb0...	Office 365 Exchange Onl...

Figure 6: Identifying sign-in events correlating with the email.

Once the sign-on events occurred, I verified if any endpoint activity occurred. At 10:24 AM, an alert for malicious endpoint activity was triggered, leading me to pivot towards identifying endpoint compromise of the VM.

↑ ↓ ×

(o)

2001:19f0:7401:8e95:5400:6ff:fed3:57f2

→ Open IP address page

+ Add endpoint indicator

...

ec1m

Detection

3 active alerts in 1 incidents

Info (0)

Low (0)

Medium (1)

High (2)

[View all incidents & alerts in IP page](#)

IP observed in organization devices

Filter by: 30 days

Count 0

Entity Reputation

Unknown (0/100)

Log activity ⓘ

First seen10/7/2026, 10:30:20 AM

Last seen10/7/2026, 10:48:31 AM

Data Sources

[SecurityAlert](#)

Logged hosts ⓘ

Host name

First seen

Last seen

Hosts were not found

Open IP address page

Figure 8: Confirming Sign in from unfamiliar location.

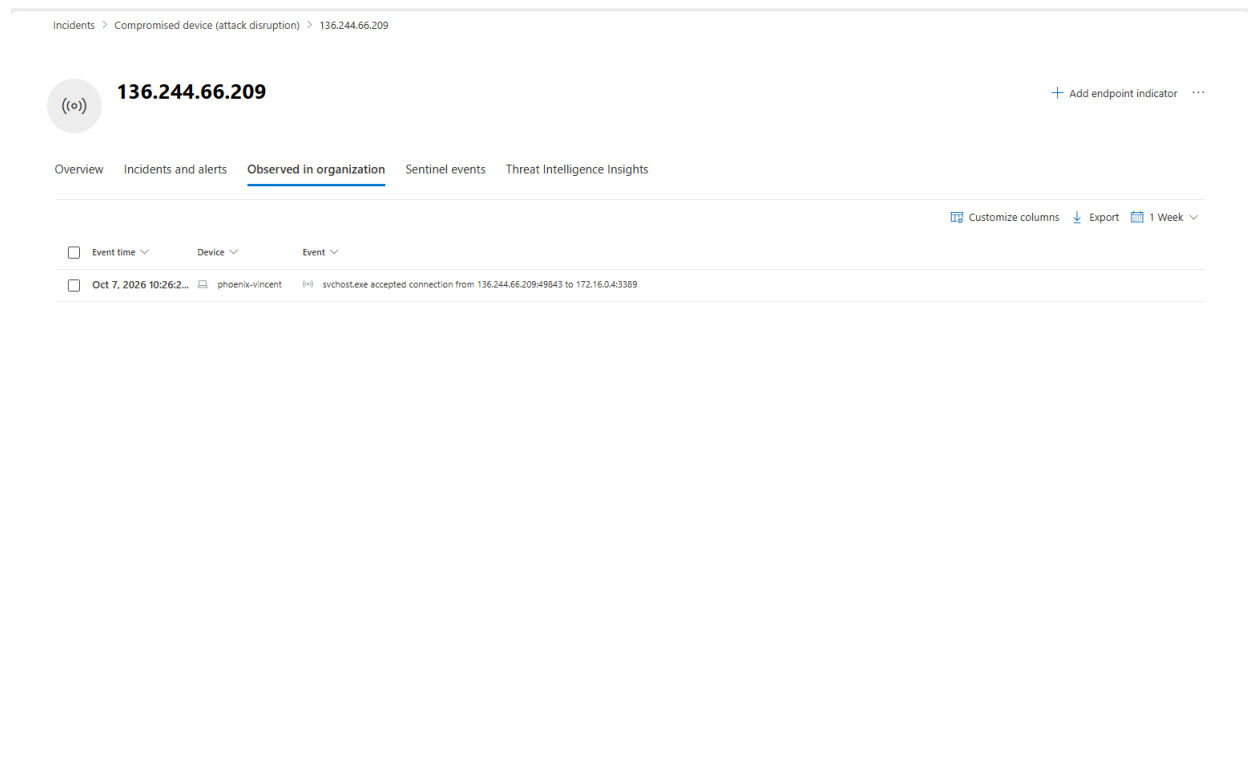


Figure 9: Confirming remote login to VM

Once I found evidence of endpoint compromise, I confirmed the compromise via Microsoft Defender XDR. We can see that the account remotely logged into the VM.

Query

Run query

```
1 DeviceLoginEvents
2 | where ActionType == "LogonSuccess"
3 | where LogonType == "RemoteInteractive"
```

Results

Query history

Getting started

Export

Link to incident

Take actions

Show empty columns

1 of 3 selected

Filters: Add filter

TimeGenerated

Timestamp

DeviceId

DeviceName

☐

>

Oct 7, 2026 10:26:...

Oct 7, 2026 10:26:33 AM

b3570b06e4b2cb0e7...

phoenix-vincent

☒

>

Oct 7, 2026 10:26:...

Oct 7, 2026 10:26:33 AM

b3570b06e4b2cb0e7...

phoenix-vincent

☐

>

Oct 7, 2026 10:26:...

Oct 7, 2026 10:26:33 AM

b3570b06e4b2cb0e7...

phoenix-vincent

Inspect record

Oct 7, 2026 10:26:33 AM

DeviceId

b3570b06e4b2cb0e781cea7d27092af970cbad16

DeviceName

phoenix-vincent

ActionType

LogonSuccess

LogonType

RemoteInteractive

AccountDomain

azuread

AccountName

msscott

AccountSid

S-1-12-1-1684028655-1323739757-380533171-2352858459

Protocol

Negotiate

LogonId

1740762

RemoteIP

136.244.66.209

RemoteIPType

Public

RemotePort

0

InitiatingProcessAccountDomain

nt authority

InitiatingProcessAccountName

system

InitiatingProcessAccountSid

Figure 10: Confirming RDP login to the VM

Once the account logged into the VM, we can see that the retrieved mimikatz, a credential harvesting tool, and began to execute it.

Export						46 items	Customize columns
First seen	File name	Verdict	Remediation status	File path	Device		
Oct 7, 2026 10:33 AM	SOAPHound.exe	Malicious		C:\AtomicRedTeam\atomic\T1059.001\bin\SOAPHou...	phoenix-vincent		
Oct 7, 2026 10:31 AM	mimispool.dll	Malicious		C:\Users\MichaelScott\Downloads\mimikatz_trunkW6...	Phoenix-Vincent		
Oct 7, 2026 10:30 AM	mimikatz_trunk.zip	Malicious		C:\Users\MichaelScott\Downloads\mimikatz_trunk.zip	phoenix-vincent		
Oct 7, 2026 10:30 AM	mimispool.dll	Malicious		C:\Users\MichaelScott\Downloads\mimikatz_trunkW...	phoenix-vincent		
Oct 7, 2026 10:30 AM	mimikatz.exe	Malicious		C:\Users\MichaelScott\Downloads\mimikatz_trunkW6...	phoenix-vincent		
Oct 7, 2026 10:30 AM	mimikatz_trunk.zip	Malicious		C:\Users\MichaelScott\Downloads\mimikatz_trunk.zip	phoenix-vincent		
Oct 7, 2026 10:30 AM	mimidrv.sys	Malicious		C:\Users\MichaelScott\Downloads\mimikatz_trunkW6...	phoenix-vincent		
Oct 7, 2026 10:30 AM	mimilove.exe	Malicious		C:\Users\MichaelScott\Downloads\mimikatz_trunkW...	phoenix-vincent		
Oct 7, 2026 10:30 AM	mimilib.dll	Malicious		C:\Users\MichaelScott\Downloads\mimikatz_trunkW...	phoenix-vincent		
Oct 7, 2026 10:30 AM	mimilib.dll	Malicious		C:\Users\MichaelScott\Downloads\mimikatz_trunkW6...	phoenix-vincent		
Oct 7, 2026 10:30 AM	mimikatz.exe	Malicious		C:\Users\MichaelScott\Downloads\mimikatz_trunkW...	phoenix-vincent		
Oct 7, 2026 10:30 AM	mimikatz.exe	Malicious		C:\Users\MichaelScott\Downloads\mimikatz_trunkW6...	phoenix-vincent		
Oct 7, 2026 10:30 AM	mimispool.dll	Malicious		C:\Users\MichaelScott\Downloads\mimikatz_trunkW...	phoenix-vincent		
Oct 7, 2026 10:30 AM	mimidrv.sys	Malicious		C:\Users\MichaelScott\Downloads\mimikatz_trunkW...	phoenix-vincent		

Figure 11: Identifying malicious file execution on the VM

We can confirm that the user account downloaded the mimikatz program.

Advanced hunting

Selected workspace: phoenix-vincent-law

Help resources

New query*

New query*

Schema

FileMaliciousContentInfo

MessageEvents

MessagePostDeliveryEv...

MessageUrlInfo

UrlClickEvents

Devices

DeviceEvents

DeviceFileCertificateInfo

DeviceFileEvents

DeviceInfo

DeviceImageLoadEvents

DeviceLogonEvents

DeviceNetworkEvents

DeviceNetworkInfo

DeviceProcessEvents

DeviceRegistryEvents

DisruptionAndRespons...

Defender Vulnerability Management

DeviceTvmInfoGathering

DeviceTvmInfoGatherin...

DeviceTvmSecureConf...

DeviceTvmSecureConf...

DeviceTvmSoftwareEvid...

DeviceTvmSoftwareInve...

DeviceTvmSoftwareVul...

Query

Run query

Create summary rule

Create detection rule

100,000 (Default)

Last 12 hours

Results

Query history

Getting started

Export

Show empty columns

11 items

Search

0000.750

Low

Filters

Add filter

	TimeGenerated	DeviceName	ActionType	InitiatingProcessFil...	FileName	FolderPath	InitiatingProcessAc...
	Oct 7, 2026 10:30...	phoenix-vincent	FileCreated	msedge.exe	mimikatz_trunk.zip	C:\Users\MichaelScott\...	michaelscott
	Oct 7, 2026 10:30...	phoenix-vincent	FileCreated	explorer.exe	mimikatz_trunk.lnk	C:\Users\MichaelScott\...	michaelscott
	Oct 7, 2026 10:30...	phoenix-vincent	FileCreated	explorer.exe	mimidrv.sys	C:\Users\MichaelScott\...	michaelscott
	Oct 7, 2026 10:30...	phoenix-vincent	FileCreated	explorer.exe	mimikatz.exe	C:\Users\MichaelScott\...	michaelscott
	Oct 7, 2026 10:30...	phoenix-vincent	FileCreated	explorer.exe	mimilib.dll	C:\Users\MichaelScott\...	michaelscott
	Oct 7, 2026 10:30...	phoenix-vincent	FileCreated	explorer.exe	mimilove.exe	C:\Users\MichaelScott\...	michaelscott
	Oct 7, 2026 10:30...	phoenix-vincent	FileCreated	explorer.exe	mimispool.dll	C:\Users\MichaelScott\...	michaelscott
	Oct 7, 2026 10:30...	phoenix-vincent	FileCreated	explorer.exe	mimidrv.sys	C:\Users\MichaelScott\...	michaelscott
	Oct 7, 2026 10:30...	phoenix-vincent	FileCreated	explorer.exe	mimikatz.exe	C:\Users\MichaelScott\...	michaelscott
	Oct 7, 2026 10:30...	phoenix-vincent	FileCreated	explorer.exe	mimilib.dll	C:\Users\MichaelScott\...	michaelscott
	Oct 7, 2026 10:30...	phoenix-vincent	FileCreated	explorer.exe	mimispool.dll	C:\Users\MichaelScott\...	michaelscott

Figure 12: File creation events pertaining to mimikatz

I confirmed that the account executed mimikatz via PowerShell.

Query Run query Create summary rule Create detection rule 100,000 (Default) Last 12 hours

```

1 DeviceProcessEvents
2 | where FileName contains "mimikatz"
3 | or ProcessCommandLine contains "mimikatz"
4 | project Timestamp, DeviceName, AccountName, FileName, ProcessCommandLine, InitiatingProcessFileName

```

Results Query history Getting started

Export Show empty columns 1 item Search 00:01:312 Low Grid Table Full Screen Refresh

Filters: Add filter

☐	Timestamp	DeviceName	AccountName	FileName	ProcessCommandL...	InitiatingProcessFil...
☐	Oct 7, 2026 10:31:...	phoenix-vincent	michaelscott	mimikatz.exe	mimikatz.exe	powershell.exe
Timestamp		Oct 7, 2026 10:31:32 AM				
DeviceName		phoenix-vincent				
AccountName		michaelscott				
FileName		mimikatz.exe				
ProcessCommandLine		mimikatz.exe				
InitiatingProcessFileName		powershell.exe				

Figure 13: confirming Mimikatz execution.

We can also see that SOAPHound, an active directory enumeration tool was executed via PowerShell to perform domain enumeration.

Query Run query Create summary rule Create detection rule 100,000 (Default) Last 12 hours

```

1 DeviceProcessEvents
2 | where FileName has "SOAPHound"
3 | or ProcessCommandLine has "SOAPHound"
4 | project TimeGenerated, DeviceName, AccountName, InitiatingProcessFileName, InitiatingProcessCommandLine, ProcessCommandLine

```

Results Query history Getting started

Export Link to incident Take actions Show empty columns 1 of 4 selected Search 00:01:20 Low Grid Table Full Screen Refresh

Filters: Add filter

☐	TimeGenerated	DeviceName	AccountName	InitiatingProcessFil...	InitiatingProcessCo...	ProcessCommandL...
☐	Oct 7, 2026 10:33:...	phoenix-vincent	michaelscott	powershell.exe	powershell.exe	"powershell.exe" & {C:\A...
☒	Oct 7, 2026 10:33:...	phoenix-vincent	michaelscott	powershell.exe	"powershell.exe" & {C:\A...	"SOAPHound.exe" --use...
TimeGenerated		Oct 7, 2026 10:33:42 AM				
DeviceName		phoenix-vincent				
AccountName		michaelscott				
InitiatingProcessFileName		powershell.exe				
InitiatingProcessCommandLine		"powershell.exe" & {C:\AtomicRedTeam\atomics\T1059.001\bin\SOAPHound.exe --user \$env:USERNAME --password ***** --domain \$en				
ProcessCommandLine		"SOAPHound.exe" --user MichaelScott --password ***** --domain AzureAD --dc 10.0.1.14 --bhdump --cachefilename c:\temp\cache.txt				
☐	Oct 7, 2026 10:33:...	phoenix-vincent	michaelscott	powershell.exe	powershell.exe	"powershell.exe" & {C:\A...
☐	Oct 7, 2026 10:33:...	phoenix-vincent	michaelscott	powershell.exe	"powershell.exe" & {C:\A...	"SOAPHound.exe" --use...

Figure 14: identifying further malicious activity.

Recommendations

Though this incident is a simulation of an email, identity, and endpoint compromise, the incident should be treated as legitimate. The recommendations are as follows:

- 1) Contain and investigate the Michael Scott account
 - Temporarily disable or restrict the Michael Scott account and review recent authentication activity, logons, and sessions to determine whether the account was compromised or intentionally used to perform the activity.
 - Reset the account's credentials and review MFA status before restoring normal access.
 - Review other account authentication activity to identify further compromise.

- 2) Maintain endpoint isolation and verify Defender protections
 - If the endpoint was not Isolated, perform Isolation of the endpoint. The endpoint should remain isolated until Mimikatz.exe, and SOAPHound.exe are eradicated.
 - Conduct further investigation into the execution of Mimikatz, and Atomic Red Team.

- 3) Investigate and remediate the phishing entry point
 - Identify the original phishing email, and the malicious URL, then remove the message from other mailboxes if applicable.
 - Block the malicious URL and domain. Confirm if other users received the email.